

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF FINANCIAL TRAINING 2025

ISFT

INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL OF FINANCIAL TRAINING

OCN London BESPOKE

BESPOKE QUALIFICATION

ISFT Award in Introduction to Financial Markets

One map for every major asset class.

5	10	Level 3	Online
UNITS	CREDITS	AWARD	SELF-PACED

www.derivion.in

Centre: Derivion International Private Limited (trading as ISFT) · Course code 1131235

WHY THIS QUALIFICATION

Five markets, one shared vocabulary.

Instead of specialising early, this qualification builds a broad, structured map of how equities, FX, commodities and bonds each work — and how they relate.



Practitioner-designed

Authored by the centre's Head Educator, drawing on direct trading experience across equities, FX, commodities and fixed income in London and Chicago.



Broad by design

Built to give a structured foundation across asset classes before learners specialise into a single market.



Standardised and accredited

Delivered under OCN London (course code 1131235), with a defined credit value, level and external quality assurance.



Applied, not just informational

Learners construct and evaluate a real written comparative analysis using live market data across two asset classes.

WHO IT IS FOR

A broad foundation across every asset class.

This qualification provides a comprehensive overview of global financial markets, designed for learners who want a structured understanding of how different markets operate and interrelate, before specialising further.

Level 2 completers

Ready to broaden their view across markets.

Multi-asset explorers

Want one map before choosing a specialism.

Comparative thinkers

Interested in how markets relate to each other.

Prior learning

There is no formal barrier to entry — this is recommended.

- The Level 2 Award in Introduction to Financial Trading, or equivalent foundational knowledge of financial markets and trading
- A device with internet access to reach the Learning Management System



WHAT YOU WILL GAIN

A working view of five markets at once.



Read market structure

How exchanges, regulators and clearing houses interact.

UNIT 1



Value an equity

Basic valuation and how index trading differs from single stocks.

UNIT 2



Trade a currency pair

What moves exchange rates, and how a pair is quoted.

UNIT 3



Judge a commodity market

Supply, demand and relevance to Indian traders.

UNIT 4



Compare across asset classes

Bonds, derivatives, and a real comparative analysis.

UNIT 5

PROGRAMME AT A GLANCE

The numbers behind the programme.

A broad, evenly-weighted foundation: 5 units, 10 credits, delivered fully online at Level 3.



CREDITS BY UNIT — 2 EACH, 10 TOTAL

1	Financial Markets Overview and Structure	2
2	Equities and Stock Markets	2
3	Foreign Exchange and Currency Markets	2
4	Commodities and Energy Markets	2
5	Bonds, Interest Rates and Derivatives	2

QUALIFICATION	ISFT Award in Introduction to Financial Markets
OCN LONDON COURSE CODE	1131235
CENTRE	Derivion International Private Limited (trading as ISFT), Centre ID 160472
DELIVERY	Online, self-paced · 8–12 weeks typical
ACCREDITATION / REVIEW	Accredited 13/08/2026 · Reviewed 13/08/2027

01

Study

Video instruction and written materials.

02

Compare

Case studies across asset classes.

03

Assess

An online MCQ for each unit.

04

Report

A written comparative analysis.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Computer, laptop, tablet or smartphone
- An internet connection to the LMS
- Comfort comparing basic market data

HOW YOU LEARN

Learn online, at your own pace.

Delivered entirely online through Derivion Academy. There is no fixed timetable: learners typically finish within 8 to 12 weeks.



YOUR LEARNING JOURNEY

Five units, one connected map of the market.

1

EB1/3/LR/015

Financial Markets Overview and Structure

2 credits

2

EB1/3/LR/016

Equities and Stock Markets

2 credits

3

EB1/3/LR/017

Foreign Exchange and Currency Markets

2 credits

4

EB1/3/LR/018

Commodities and Energy Markets

2 credits

5

EB1/3/LR/019

Bonds, Interest Rates and Derivatives

2 credits

UNIT 1 · EB1/3/LR/015

Financial Markets Overview and Structure

How exchanges, regulators and clearing houses interact, and how market structures differ across developed and emerging economies.

2 credits

Level 3



01

Structure of global markets

- Explain how exchanges, regulators and clearing houses interact within a financial market
- Compare the structure of developed and emerging market exchanges, including Indian markets

The function of regulation

- Explain the role of a market regulator, e.g. SEBI, FCA, SEC
- Describe why regulation is important for market confidence and stability

INDICATIVE CONTENT

Global exchange structures

Regulatory bodies: SEBI, FCA, SEC

Clearing and settlement

Market confidence and integrity

UNIT 2 · EB1/3/LR/016

Equities and Stock Markets

What a share represents, how equity markets function, and the basic concepts used to value and analyse a listed company.

2 credits

Level 3

Characteristics of equity markets

- Explain what a share represents and how equity markets function
- Describe the difference between primary issuance (IPO) and secondary market trading

Analysing and trading equities

- Analyse basic valuation concepts used to assess a listed company
- Explain how index trading, e.g. Nifty, S&P 500, differs from single-stock trading

INDICATIVE CONTENT

- Shares and equity ownership
- IPOs and secondary trading
- Basic valuation concepts
- Index trading: global and Indian indices



UNIT 3 · EB1/3/LR/017

Foreign Exchange and Currency Markets

How the world's largest market operates, how a currency pair is quoted, and what drives a currency's value.

2 credits

Level 3



How the FX market operates

- Explain the structure and scale of the global FX market
- Describe how a currency pair is quoted and traded

What drives currency values

- Identify the main economic and political factors affecting exchange rates
- Identify the likely impact of a given economic event on a specified currency pair

INDICATIVE CONTENT

- FX market structure and scale
- Currency pair quoting conventions
- Drivers of currency value
- INR in the context of global FX

UNIT 4 · EB1/3/LR/018

Commodities and Energy Markets

Hard versus soft commodities, who trades them and how, and why gold and crude oil matter to Indian traders and investors.

2 credits

Level 3

Structure of commodity markets

- Explain the difference between hard and soft commodities
- Identify the main participants and exchanges operating in commodity and energy markets
- Describe how commodities and energy products are typically traded

What drives commodity prices

- Identify supply and demand factors affecting a named commodity
- Identify the relevance of commodity markets, e.g. gold, crude oil, to Indian traders and investors

INDICATIVE CONTENT

Hard vs soft commodities

Spot and futures trading

Supply and demand drivers

Gold and crude oil in Indian markets



UNIT 5 · EB1/3/LR/019

Bonds, Interest Rates and Derivatives

How bonds generate returns, the basic role of futures and options, and applying it all in a real comparative analysis.

2 credits

Level 3



Bonds and fixed income

- Explain what a bond represents and how it generates returns for an investor
- Describe the relationship between bond prices and interest rates

The role of derivatives

- Explain the purpose of futures and options contracts
- Describe how derivatives can be used for hedging or speculation

Applying knowledge across asset classes

- Select recent, real market data for at least two different asset classes and summarise current conditions in each
- Evaluate the two asset classes, applying relevant concepts such as valuation and risk/return characteristics

INDICATIVE CONTENT

Bond basics and yield

Price / interest-rate relationship

Futures and options

Hedging vs speculation

Comparative analysis across asset classes

UNIT 5 · APPLIED TASK

One market alone doesn't tell the full story.

Unit 5 ends with a written comparative analysis: real, recent market data for two different asset classes, evaluated side by side.

800–1,200

words, written comparative market analysis report

Assessed by the Head Educator against a published marking brief.

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS REPORT

Real market data, two asset classes

Pick two asset classes

Real, recent market data for each

Summarise current conditions

For each asset class in turn

Evaluate side by side

Valuation and risk/return characteristics

EB1/3/LR/015	Financial Markets Overview and Structure	MCQ
EB1/3/LR/016	Equities and Stock Markets	MCQ
EB1/3/LR/017	Foreign Exchange and Currency Markets	MCQ
EB1/3/LR/018	Commodities and Energy Markets	MCQ
EB1/3/LR/019	Bonds, Interest Rates and Derivatives	MCQ + report

25 questions · 50 minutes · 70% pass mark on every MCQ · comparative report is 800–1,200 words

MCQ: recognition level

Where criteria say explain, describe or compare, you select the correct answer from plausible alternatives.

Report: application

Criteria that ask you to select, apply or evaluate are assessed through the Unit 5 written report.

ASSESSMENT

How you're assessed.

Each unit closes with an online MCQ, auto-marked on the LMS. Unit 5 adds a written comparative analysis report.



QUALITY AND STANDARDS

Standards you can rely on.

Assessment is quality-assured at every stage, and the qualification is reviewed every year.



1 Set

Activities are set internally by tutor/assessors so learners can meet the learning outcomes and assessment criteria.

2 Moderated

Assessed evidence is internally moderated at the centre, unless it is computer-assessed.

3 Externally verified

An OCN London External Quality Assurer moderates externally.

4 Reviewed every year

The Head Educator reviews the qualification annually, informed by learner feedback, IQA assessment-outcome analysis and OCN London Quality Engagement reports.



WHERE THIS LEADS

Your next step in financial markets.

On completion, learners may progress to specialised Level 3 Awards:

- Introduction to Trading Government Bonds Award
- Introduction to Technical Analysis in Trading Certificate

Awarding organisation: OCN London · Course code 1131235

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